

Communication Partner Guide

A short training for family, school staff, respite providers, medical teams, and community partners.

No account

No ads

No cloud profile

Works offline after loading

Presume competence. The device is the person's voice, not a reward, lesson, or behavior-control tool.

The six partner habits

1	Keep access The board stays within reach, charged, and available across settings.
2	Model Tap a few words while you speak naturally. No copying is required.
3	Wait Pause after a model or question. Do not rush to fill the silence.
4	Respond Treat a meaningful tap or combination as communication.
5	Confirm If uncertain, reflect the message: "You said stop. Do you want this to stop?"
6	Repair together Offer Find, yes/no, gestures, writing, or choices without taking over the message.

Say this / avoid this

Supportive	Avoid
"I'm listening."	"Use your words."
"Take your time."	Repeated prompts or countdowns
"You said no. I hear you."	Ignoring no or stop
Modeling "I want music"	"Find want. Now find music."
"I'm not sure. Show me another way."	Guessing and moving on

Safety, privacy, and dignity

- ☐ Never remove access as a consequence.
- ☐ Do not read private saved information aloud unless the communicator requests it or safety requires it.
- ☐ Honor stop, no, pain, bathroom, and help immediately enough to establish trust.
- ☐ Do not photograph, post, or share a person's communication without permission.
- ☐ Keep a low-tech backup available when charging, updating, or repairing the device.

Partner practice

Practice these before supporting the communicator in a high-pressure moment.

- ☐ Find and model: I want to go home
- ☐ Find and model: I do not like that
- ☐ Find and model: where is my phone
- ☐ Use Find to locate an unfamiliar word
- ☐ Switch between Full and Simple View
- ☐ Speak a Quick phrase
- ☐ Locate My Info without changing it

Team agreement

We will keep the system available, model without demanding, wait for communication, honor clear refusals, and report vocabulary needs to the person's primary support team.

Partner name	Role	Date

If the board does not speak, remain calm. Preserve the person's message using pointing, writing, gestures, or a backup board while the device is checked.